

Bucharest University of Economic Studies
Faculty of Cybernetics, Statistics and Economic Informatics

Internship Project
**Website Design and Front-End Development in WordPress Including
Logo Creation**

Academic coordinator: Ilie-Nemedi Iulian
Student: Al Sammarraie Nooruldeen Sameer Fawzi

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Introduction

During my internship at the Informality Data Research Lab (IDRL), part of INCSMPS, I was responsible for the complete design and front-end development of the lab's official website (<https://informality.ro>), integrating my own visual concepts into WordPress and crafting a custom logo to reinforce the brand identity. My role spanned wireframing and prototyping, setting up site infrastructure, delivering a cohesive brand look and feel, customizing the CMS, and coding the responsive user interface. I used Figma to develop all design assets from the logo to page mockups and then brought these assets to life within WordPress. By the end of the project, the site was successfully launched in a team-wide conference, showcasing a seamless blend of creative design and technical execution.

This internship allowed me to apply theoretical knowledge in a real-world project, gain practical experience with CMS tools, and understand the process of launching a functional and optimized website from start to finish.

1. General Presentation of the Organization

The Informality Data Research Lab (IDRL) is a research initiative under the National Scientific Research Institute for Labour and Social Protection (INCSMPS). Established in 2024, the lab focuses on analyzing informal employment and vulnerable labor groups to support evidence-based policymaking. IDRL collaborates with academic institutions, public authorities, and NGOs, and maintains a commitment to transparency and public engagement through its online presence. To support transparency and public engagement, IDRL launched an official website that presents its mission, research areas, ongoing projects, and events. The platform plays a key role in ensuring **access to information**, increasing institutional visibility, and promoting dialogue around labour market informality.

2. Technologies Used During the Internship

- Figma: For wireframing, prototyping, and creating high-fidelity designs including the site layout, logo, and certificate templates.
- WordPress: As the content management system to implement all designs, configure themes, and manage site content.
- HTML5 & CSS3: For custom front-end styling and responsive layout adjustments beyond the theme defaults.
- JavaScript (vanilla): To enhance interactive elements and ensure dynamic behavior on the client side.
- Browser Developer Tools: To debug layout issues, test responsiveness, and refine performance.
- Git: For version control of custom code snippets and style sheets.

3. Project Activities and Timeline

- Wireframing and Prototyping: Developing interactive mockups in Figma to align on layout and user flow.
- Setting Up Site Infrastructure: Installing WordPress on staging; configuring theme and initial plugins.
- Creating the Brand Identity: Designing the logo, selecting typography, and defining a color scheme.

- Content Management System Customization: Tailoring menus, page templates, and custom fields.
- User Experience (UX) & User Interface (UI): Applying design system components for consistency and accessibility.
- Front-End Development: Translating Figma designs into HTML, CSS, and JS within WordPress theme files.
- Regular Updates and Maintenance: Iterating on design tweaks, content updates, and plugin patches.

4. Website Design and Front-End Development in WordPress

- Logo and identity
- Home Page: Featured a hero banner, key research highlights, and quick links.
- About Us: Showcased the lab's mission, team biographies, and timeline.
- Research Areas: Interactive cards outlining each focus topic.
- Projects & Publications: Custom templates for project case studies and publication lists.
- Events & Workshops: Calendar integration and responsive event cards.
- Contact Page: Embedded form and Google Maps section.
- Certifications for lab members



Figure 1

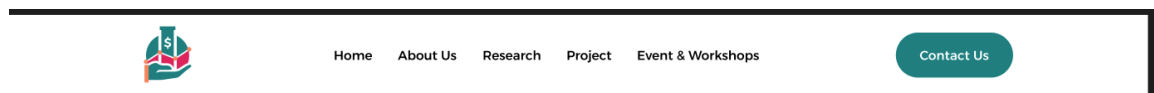


Figure 2



Advancing inclusive development
through data-driven research on
informal economies.

Quick Links

Home	Project
About Us	Event & Workshops
Research	Contact Us

Contact Information

	Bucuresti
	077230277
	IDRL@gmail.com

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Figure 3

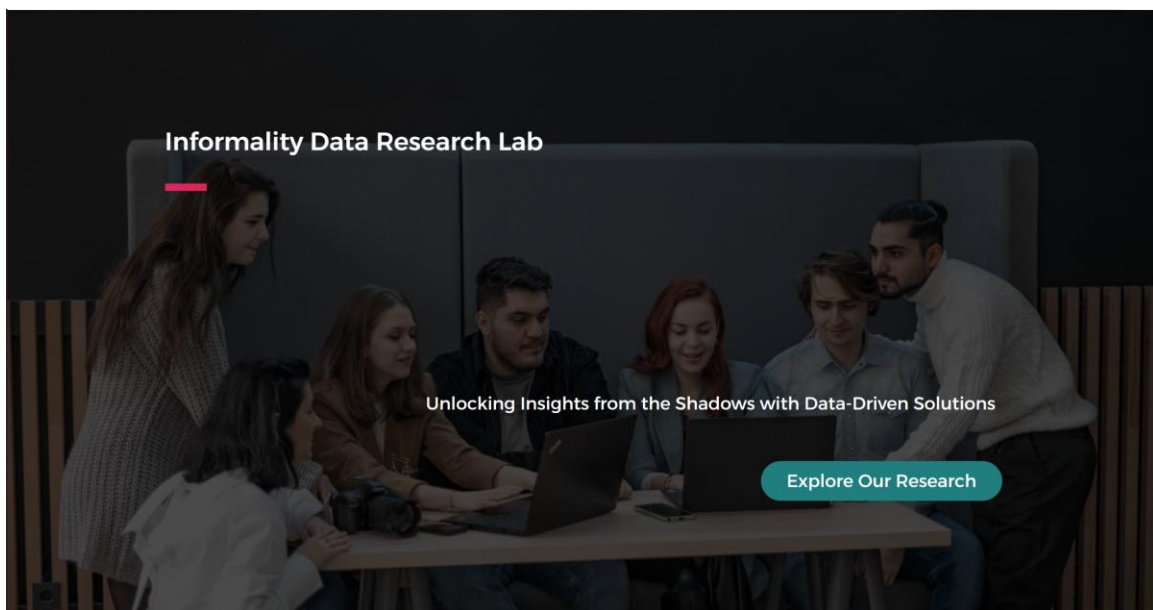


Figure 4

About us

Established in 2024, the **Informality Data Research Lab** operates within the National Scientific Research Institute for Labour and Social Protection as a research group dedicated to analyzing and empirically quantifying informality at the European level.



Mission Statement

We explore new perspectives to understand and address informality. Through advanced research and data-driven solutions, we bring the challenges and opportunities of the informal economy to the forefront.

Figure 5

Key Research Areas

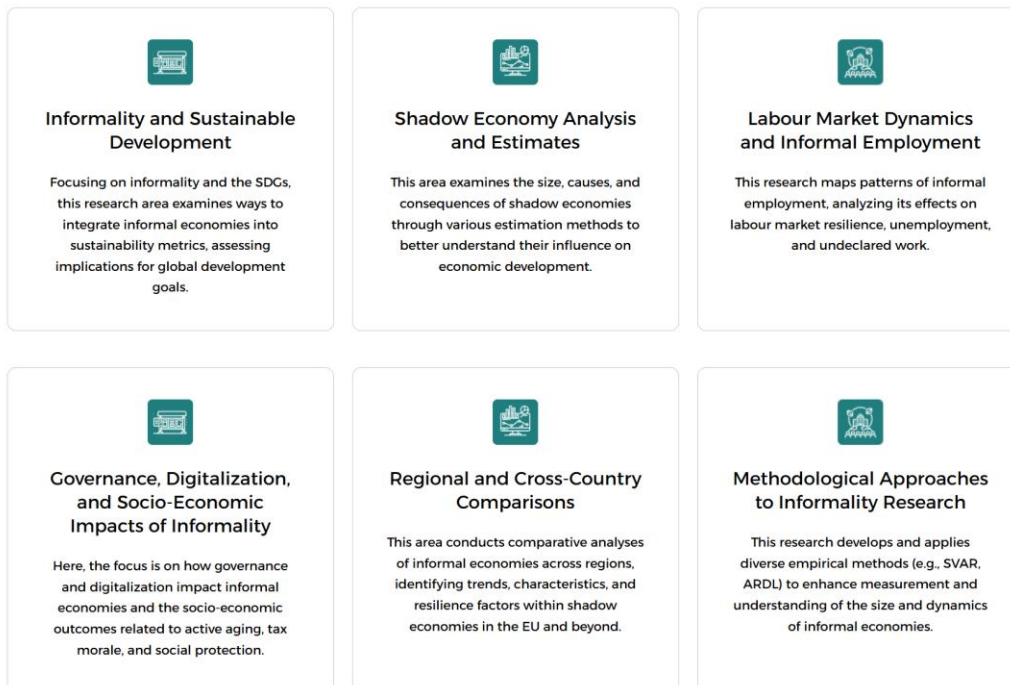


Figure 6

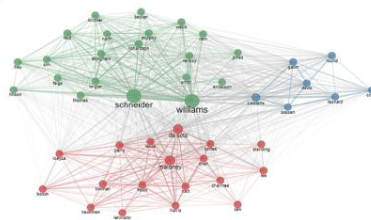
Explore Our Research

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Stay Informed through our newsletter

Engage with us

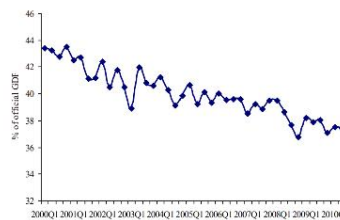
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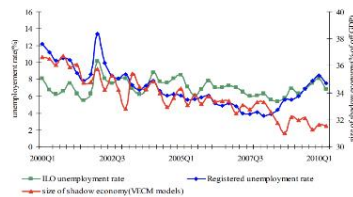
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Figure 7

David Adrian Lițescu

Web Developer and Data Integration Specialist at Informality.ro

“Data and technology solve complex problems and create impactful change.”

[See Profile](#)



Nooruldeen Al Sammarraie

Web Developer and Data Integration Specialist at Informality.ro

“Technology turns vision into reality, transforming barriers into gateways.”

[See Profile](#)

Figure 8

Nooruldeen Al Sammarraie

Web Developer and Data Integration Specialist at Informality.ro



Al Sammarraie Nooruldeen, also known as Noor, is a student in the Economics Informatics bachelor's program at the Bucharest Academy of Economic Studies. He graduated from high school in Baghdad, Iraq, and is fluent in three languages: Arabic, English, and Romanian. Along with his best friend and colleague David, Noor worked on several projects, including an in-depth analysis of how corruption drives protests and migration. Together, they consistently achieved top marks throughout their college journey. Noor is a passionate designer and served as the lead designer for both the website and the identity of Informality. With extensive knowledge in UI/UX design and a strong interest in economics, Noor continues to excel in both creative and analytical fields. Bringing a different perspective to the table. Noor is also highly skilled with computers and technology, with a deep understanding of various software tools and programming languages. His passion for learning allows him to quickly grasp new concepts, whether in economics, design, or IT. In addition to his academic pursuits, Noor owns and manages a retail store, showcasing his entrepreneurial spirit and leadership skills. Outside of his professional endeavors, he has a keen eye for photography, often blending his love for visual aesthetics with his technical expertise. His diverse interests and skills make him a well-rounded individual, ready to tackle challenges across multiple disciplines.

Figure 9

[View More](#)

Publications

Our extensive body of research is publicly available, contributing to the ongoing conversation around informality and economic policy. Below is a list of our most recent publications. Each paper can be accessed via DOI references or downloaded directly.



Figure 10



LinkedIn
Link.example.com



Email
idri.contact@example.com



Location
3891 Ranchview Dr.
Richardson, California 62639



Timings
Mon - Sat : 8:00 - 10:00
Sun : Off

Join Our Team

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Nulla velit nibh, mattis non augue et, tempor vulputate ex. Nunc a ex metus.

Your Name

Email address

Phone Number

Subject

Message

Send Message

Find Us on Google Map

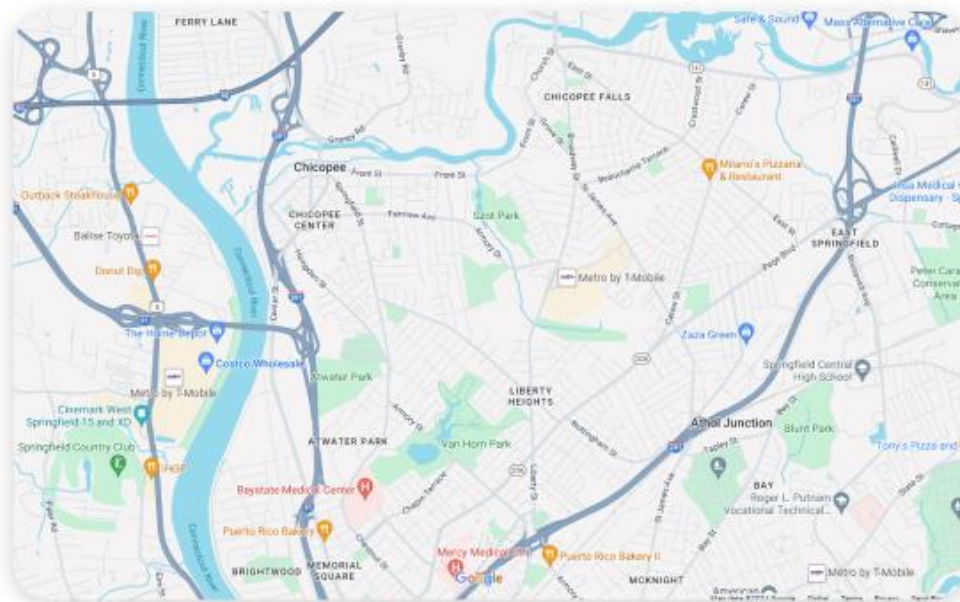


Figure 11



Figure 12

5. Challenges and Solutions

- Creative Alignment: Iterating on visual concepts to match stakeholder feedback addressed by scheduling daily design reviews in Figma.
- Tool Integration: Synchronizing Figma exports with WordPress theming overcame by establishing a clear naming convention for assets and local testing.
- Responsive Edge Cases: Ensuring the UI held up on small screens solved through targeted CSS media queries and live device testing.

6. Final Testing and Deployment

- Cross-browser and device compatibility tests.
- Accessibility audit against WCAG 2.1 AA standards.
- Performance checks using Google Lighthouse.
- Backup scheduling setup on the production server.
- Migrated the site from staging to the live domain and held a conference demonstration.

Conclusions

This internship deepened my expertise at the intersection of design and development. Leading the visual concept from wireframe to live code taught me how to maintain design

fidelity throughout the production pipeline. I strengthened my skills in Figma for rapid prototyping, refined my WordPress theming workflow, and learned to anticipate and solve real-world responsiveness and performance issues. Collaborating with researchers and developers also reinforced the importance of clear communication and iterative feedback. Overall, I emerged with a robust process for translating creative vision into an accessible, high-quality web experience.

Bibliography

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